

Eight-Day European Alps Motorcycle Tour

~2,400 km / ~1,500 mi

MOTORCYCLE RENTAL — MUNICH

The recommended rental shop near Munich Airport is Allround Motorcycle Renting:

www.motorradvermietung.de/muenchen/en/

Other options: Motorradvermietung (motorradvermietung-hamburg.de), Moto Tours Europe (mototourseurope.com), BMW Rent a Ride (rentaride.bmw-motorrad.com)

ROAD FEES & VIGNETTES

- **Austria:** Austria 10-day vignette: €4.90 (covers Days 1 & 8). Grossglockner day toll: ~€36.50.
- **Switzerland:** Swiss annual vignette: CHF 40 (~€42). No per-km tolls — covers all Swiss sections.
- **Italy:** Italian autostrada: ~€0.09/km. Tunnels/passes: flat fees.

BEST TIME TO GO

- **Best:** early to mid-September. Every pass is open, the summer crowds have gone home, and the weather is usually settled.
- **Good:** late June to mid-July. Long days and wildflowers, with snow still on the peaks. Most passes open in June, but the highest (Stelvio, Umbrail, Furka) can open late after a snowy winter.
- **Avoid:** late July and August. European holidays bring the heaviest traffic on the passes, especially around Ferragosto (August 15) in Italy.
- **Latest:** late September. Early snow can close the high passes from October.

ARRIVAL DAY

Fly into Munich International Airport · Settle in Erding · Bike Pickup Tomorrow



Tonight: Hotel zum ERDINGER Weißbräu, Lange Zeile 1, 85435 Erding

Recommended by the rental shop, Allround Motorcycle Renting near the airport

✦ WHAT TO DO IN ERDING THIS EVENING



Erdinger Weissbräu Brewery Tour The world's largest wheat beer brewery is right here — tour the facility or simply enjoy fresh Weißbier at the hotel restaurant.



Therme Erding The largest thermal spa in the world is just a short ride away — perfect for relaxing jet-lagged muscles before the big adventure begins.



Route Check & Gear Prep Spend the evening reviewing Day 1's route, checking tire pressure, and confirming the Grossglockner road is open (grossglockner.at).



Final Gear Pickup If you need last-minute items, the city of Munich is 40 min away with every moto gear shop imaginable.

PREP DAY

Bike Pickup

DAY 1

Munich, Germany → Lienz, Austria

 266 km / 165 mi ·  ~6 hrs riding + stops

Route Overview

An epic Alpine opener: Start with smooth highways and serene Bavarian lakes, cross into Austria through charming Tyrolean valleys, then tackle the legendary **Grossglockner High Alpine Road** (36 thrilling hairpins, glaciers, wildflower meadows, and 360° panoramas) before descending into the dramatic Dolomites gateway of East Tyrol.

Segment 1: Munich to Chiemsee & Austrian border (approx. 1.5–2 hours, ~120 km via A8/A93)

Start your day by picking up the rental bikes in Munich. Roll south on smooth German highways (A8/A93), quickly leaving the city behind as you enter the picturesque Bavarian countryside.

The road unwinds through gentle rolling hills dotted with traditional farms and forests. Make your first relaxed stop at sparkling **Chiemsee**—known as the "Bavarian Sea." Park near the lakeshore for panoramic views across the water to the island palaces of Herreninsel and Fraueninsel, with the distant Alps rising on the horizon. It's an ideal spot for photos, a quick coffee, or stretching your legs along the shoreline path.

Segment 2: Border crossing to Zell am See (approx. 1–1.5 hours, ~80 km via A93/B178/B311)

Continue south and cross seamlessly into Austria near the dramatic **Kufstein Fortress**, perched high above the Inn Valley like a medieval sentinel. The landscape shifts to lush green meadows and classic Tyrolean charm as you wind through friendly towns such as St. Johann in Tirol and the narrow, rocky Lofer gorge, where sheer cliffs create dramatic riding moments.

Arrive at **Zell am See**, an emerald lake ringed by towering 3,000 m peaks and bordered by Hohe Tauern National Park. Pull over on the lakeside promenade for a perfect mid-morning breather. Grab a seat with views of the water reflecting the surrounding mountains, watch the boats, and capture those classic Alpine postcard shots. The

town's medieval roots and cobblestone streets add extra atmosphere if you want a short wander.

[tripadvisor.com](https://www.tripadvisor.com)

Segment 3: Zell am See to Grossglockner High Alpine Road & Edelweißspitze (approx. 45–60 min riding + stops, via B311/B107)

From Zell am See, head toward Bruck and turn onto the crown jewel of the day: the **Grossglockner High Alpine Road** (B107). Pay the motorcycle day toll (approx. €36.50 at 2026 rates; check [grossglockner.at](https://www.grossglockner.at) for current rates and conditions—the road is typically open early May to early November).

Climb steadily past cascading waterfalls and meadows filled with edelweiss. Detour up the short side road to **Edelweißspitze** (2,571 m / ~8,435 ft) for one of the most spectacular 360° panoramas in the Alps—on clear days you can see over 30 peaks above 3,000 m and up to 19 glaciers. The viewing platforms and short walks here are perfect for photos and soaking in the high-alpine air. Continue along the road to **Kaiser-Franz-Josefs-Höhe** for intimate views of the massive **Pasterze Glacier** and Austria's highest summit, the **Grossglockner** (3,798 m / ~12,461 ft).

[youtube.com](https://www.youtube.com)

Segment 4: Grossglockner descent to Lienz (approx. 1–1.5 hours, ~70 km via B107/B106)

Descend the exhilarating series of 36 hairpin switchbacks, enjoying sweeping views at every turn. Pass through the postcard-perfect village of **Heiligenblut**, where the iconic onion-domed church sits dramatically framed by jagged peaks—another prime photo stop.

The road then eases into the forested Mölltal Valley before following the serene Drau River into vibrant **Lienz**, nestled at the base of the striking Lienz Dolomites. This marks your entry into the gateway of the Eastern Dolomites.

Hotel: Grandhotel Lienz Business-Wellness & Gourmet (Schlössle 9, 9900 Lienz).

<https://www.grandhotel-lienz.com/de>

Day 2: Lienz, Austria to Schlanders, Italy (Dolomites) | 265 km, 5.5 hr

The 5-hour, 265 km drive via E66 and Strada Statale 51 di Alemagna weaves through the UNESCO-listed Dolomites, crossing from Austria into Italy's South Tyrol and Veneto regions. Mid-June brings blooming wildflowers (edelweiss and alpine roses), lush green meadows, and temperatures around 15–22°C at lower elevations, dropping to 5–10°C on passes—pack layers for crisp mornings. All key passes (Giau, Pordoi, Sella) are typically open by late May, with Giau specifically from May 24 to October 12 in 2025, so expect clear roads but watch for cyclists and occasional maintenance. Tolls include Italian autostrada fees (~€5–10) and possible pass vignettes. This route overlaps the legendary Sellaronda circuit, offering jaw-dropping limestone pinnacles, glimpses of glaciers, and WWII history. I've segmented highlights below with quick stops and viewpoints.

Segment 1: Lienz to Cortina d'Ampezzo (1 hr 23 min, 77.9 km via B100, E66/SS49, SS51)

Start in East Tyrol's wide Puster Valley, transitioning to the rugged Dobbiaco Plateau—prime for early summer hikes amid larch forests and hay meadows.

- **Puster Valley (E66/SS49, first 20–30 min):** Roll through apple orchards and pastel villages like Bruneck (Brunico), with jagged peaks like the Zillertal Alps framing the scene. Stop in Toblach (Dobbiaco) for a lakeside breather at Lago di Dobbiaco—crystal waters reflect the three peaks of the Cadini di Misurina, perfect for birdwatching or a short forest trail.
- **Strada Statale 51 di Alemagna (SS51, ~45 min in):** This historic "Alemagna Road" climbs through pine-scented woods and avalanche-scarred valleys, with hairpin views of the Sexten Dolomites. Pull over near Carbonin for panoramas of the Tre Cime di Lavaredo (Drei Zinnen) spires—hike the easy 1 km path if time allows, or just snap the postcard shot.
- **Cortina d'Ampezzo Arrival:** Dubbed the "Queen of the Dolomites," this chic 1956 Winter Olympics host buzzes with mid-June markets. Stroll Corso Italia for gelato and views of the Tofane massif; the Olympic Ice Stadium adds a fun retro vibe.

Segment 2: Cortina to Passo Giau (36 min, 20.3 km via SR48, SP638)

A short but thrilling ascent via the "Falzarego-Giau" ridge, dodging tunnels for open-air drama—watch for chamois on rocky ledges.

- **Falzarego Pass Detour Vibes (SR48 early on):** Though not directly on route, the climb echoes WWI battlefields; spot ruined trenches and memorials amid wild rhubarb blooms.
- **Passo Giau Summit (2,236m):** One of the Dolomites' most photogenic passes, with sweeping vistas of the Nuvolao's "cloud-like" towers and distant Marmolada Glacier. In mid-June, meadows explode in purple crocuses—park at the rifugio for a 20-minute loop trail or espresso with 360° views over Lago di Corlo. It's a Sellaronda highlight, often less crowded than its neighbors.

Segment 3: Passo Giau to Pordoi Pass (58 min, 38.6 km via SP638/SP251, SR203, SR48/SS48)

Descend into the Cordevole Valley, then climb via Arabba's meadows—expect hairpin thrills and Marmolada's "Queen of the Dolomites" looming.

- **Colle Santa Lucia to Arabba (SP251/SR203, ~20–30 min):** Wind through larch groves and WWII Lagazuoi tunnels (view from afar). In Arabba, a lively ski village turned summer hub, grab strudel at a malga (alpine hut) with balcony views of the Sella Group.
- **Strada Dolomites/SS48 Ascent:** Hairpins reveal layered limestone walls glowing pink at sunset (or golden in morning light). Spot paragliders launching from cliffs.
- **Pordoi Pass Arrival (2,239m):** Second-highest paved pass, gateway to the Sella Plateau. Ride the cable car (€30 round-trip) for eye-level views of the Puez-

Odle peaks and eternal snowfields—mid-June's melt creates mini-waterfalls. Rifugio Maria offers panoramic lunches; it's a top spot for marmot spotting.

Segment 4: Pordoi Pass to Sella Pass (22 min, 12.9 km via SS48, SS242)

A breezy connector on the Sellaronda loop—short but packed with "wow" moments amid the Sella's fortress-like towers.

- **Passo Pordoi to Canazei Descent (SS48):** Quick drop through Val di Fassa's wildflower fields, with the Contrin Valley's streams rushing below.
- **Sella Pass Summit (2,244m):** Highest on the Sellaronda, flanked by the Sassolungo's shark-fin ridges and Sassopiatto's sheer walls. Hike the 1-hour Panscera Trail for close-up dolomite drama, or picnic amid edelweiss blooms—June's soft light makes the rock formations pop like a fantasy set. Seasonal rifugios serve Tyrolean dumplings with valley views.

Segment 5: Sella Pass to Schlanders (2 hr 1 min, 116 km via SS242, SS12, SS38)

Ease into Val Gardena's Ladin culture, then the apple-laden Venosta Valley—flatter roads with orchards replacing peaks.

- **Val Gardena/SS242 (first 30–45 min):** Cruise past Ortisei's woodcarving workshops and cable cars to Seceda's meadows. Stop in Selva for a fondue break overlooking the Odle Geisler peaks—mid-June brings cowbell symphonies from grazing herds.
- **SS12 through Bolzano Area (~1 hr in):** Urban interlude with vineyard-draped hills; detour to Lago di Caldaro for a swim if warm.
- **Venosta Valley/SS38 Approach (final 30 min):** Dramatic shift to orchards and castles like Juval, with the Ortler Alps on the horizon. Schlanders (Silandro) welcomes with its medieval arcades and apple blossom scents, ending at a heuriger (wine tavern) for Alto Adige whites.

This route is a Dolomites dream: epic passes, zero boredom. Drive cautiously on curves, and check [viabilità.it](https://viabilita.it) for real-time conditions. Buona strada!

Hotel: Hotel Engel

https://www.mein-tourenhotel.de/motorcycle_tour_overnight_at_hotel_in_schluderns

Underground parking and biker wash kit (rags, tools, maps); group discounts and luggage storage; excellent for South Tyrol loops with staff route suggestions; wellness area.

Day 3: Schlanders, Italy to Chur, Switzerland | 255 km, 5 hr

The 5-hour, 255 km drive via SS38 snakes through Italy's South Tyrol into Switzerland's Engadin Valley, tackling legendary passes like Stelvio and Bernina—UNESCO World Heritage gems. Mid-June means vibrant wildflower carpets (gentians and saxifrages), greening pastures with grazing sheep, and lingering snow patches on peaks, with valley temps at 15–22°C cooling to 5–12°C at altitude (layer up!). Most passes open by late May/early June, but Umbrail may just be clearing (expected mid-June—check alpen-paesse.ch en route). Tolls: ~€10–15 for Swiss vignette + Italian fees; Stelvio/Bernina free but prepare for hairpins and cyclists. This "Passo dello Stelvio to Engadin" odyssey blends Italian flair with Swiss precision—pure alpine euphoria.

Segment 1: Schlanders to Stelvio Pass (57 min, 41.7 km via SS38)

Launch from Venosta's orchard heartland into the Ortler Alps' dramatic ascent—48 hairpin turns to Europe's second-highest paved pass (2,757m).

- **Venosta Valley Orchards (first 10–15 min):** Golden apple groves heavy with early fruit line the Noce River; mid-June's sun dapples through leaves. Stop in Prad for a strudel tasting amid blooming elderflowers—quintessential Südtirol picnic vibes.
- **SS38 Climb to Stelvio:** Switchbacks reveal terraced meadows and cascading streams from the Ortler Glacier. Spot ibex on cliffs; the air turns pine-fresh as you gain elevation.
- **Stelvio Pass Summit:** Iconic "king of passes" with 360° panoramas of 50+ peaks, including the eternal snows of Ortler (3,906m). Park at the rifugio for gelato and a short loop to the old customs post—June's melt feeds mini-waterfalls, and wild rhododendrons add pink pops.

Segment 2: Stelvio Pass to Santa Maria Val Müstair (26 min, 16.3 km via Umbrail Pass)

A gentle descent into Switzerland via the Umbrail's smoother grades—border hop with zero fuss, entering the secluded Val Müstair.

- **Umbrail Pass Crossing (2,501m, ~10 min in):** Less crowded Stelvio alternative with sweeping views of the Sesvenna Group's jagged skyline. Mid-June's thaw brings rushing brooks; pull over for photos of the pass's stone Madonna chapel against blue skies.
- **Descent to Engadin:** Lush subalpine forests give way to hay meadows; cross into Graubünden's bilingual charm.
- **Santa Maria Val Müstair Arrival:** This UNESCO-listed valley's gem, home to Europe's oldest intact church (St. John's Abbey, 8th-century frescoes). Stroll the car-free paths amid larch blooms—grab raclette at a Gasthaus for a cultural breather.

Segment 3: Santa Maria to Bernina Pass (1 hr 19 min, 60.3 km via Route 28, Munt la Schera Tunnel, Forcola di Livigno)

Tunnel through to duty-free Livigno, then climb the Bernina's glacier-flanked spine—Rhaetian Railway views bonus if you spot the red trains.

- **Munt la Schera Tunnel (~15 min, €35 toll/car):** Quick 4 km bore under the Livigno Lake reservoir; emerges in Italy's tax-free haven—stock up on watches or chocolate in Livigno's pedestrian zone, with mid-June markets buzzing.
- **Forcola di Livigno Ascent (2,424m):** Winding through wild valleys with marmot whistles; overlooks the Bernina Group's ice fields glowing in morning light.
- **Bernina Pass Summit (2,328m):** Alpine crossroads with Lago Bianco's turquoise meltwaters mirroring Piz Bernina (4,049m, Switzerland's only 4,000m peak). Hike the 30-minute trail to the Pers Glacier viewpoint—June's soft sun on crevasses is magical; Ospizio Bernina hut serves hearty barley soup.

Segment 4: Bernina Pass to Flüela Pass (1 hr 8 min, 66.2 km via Route 29/27/28)

East-west traverse of the Upper Engadin's lake-dotted plateau—flatter than predecessors but laced with postcard lakes and larch groves.

- **Poschiavo Valley Descent (~20 min):** Switchbacks plunge into Italian-speaking valleys with chestnut woods; Poschiavo's palm-lined piazza offers espresso amid subtropical oddities (mild microclimate).
- **Alp Languard Meadows (Route 27, ~40 min in):** Rolling pastures alive with cowbells and edelweiss; detour to Diavolezza cable car (€25) for glacier panoramas without the hike.
- **Flüela Pass Arrival (2,383m):** Gateway to Davos with views of the Silvretta's snowcaps. Note potential closures, but typically open early June. Summit at the Scaletta Hut for rösti and a panorama of the pass's glacial cirques—mid-June wildflowers frame it like a painting.

Segment 5: Flüela Pass to Chur (1 hr 9 min, 70.4 km via Route 28, A13)

Descent into the Rhine's granite gorges—shift from lakes to vineyards, ending in Graubünden's ancient capital.

- **Lower Engadin (Route 28, first 20 min):** Past Susa's Roman ruins and wild rose thickets; Zernez's Ofen Pass junction hints at more adventures.
- **A13 Rhine Gorge:** Efficient motorway hugs the "Swiss Grand Canyon"—sheer walls and turquoise waters; spot eagles soaring.
- **Chur Arrival:** Switzerland's oldest city, with medieval alleys and the 800-year-old cathedral. End with a walk along the Plessur River, toasting at a Brauerei with local craft beer—perfect cap to the pass odyssey.

Epic, hairpin-packed perfection—drive steady, fuel up in Livigno. For live cams or variants, hit me up. Sichere Fahrt!

The Smallest Whiskey Bar on Earth <https://smallestwhiskybaronearth.com/>: Good things can come in small packages. The Smallest Whiskey Bar on Earth in Santa Maria Val Müstair may have only five stools, but its shelves sag under the weight of hundreds of first-class whiskeys. To keep the bar stocked, its owner, Lord Gunter Sommer, drives from the Alps to Scotland because the paperwork to deliver the bottles by air is too much of a headache. If you happen to end your day's ride in Santa Maria, pop over to the SWBOE for a nightcap. And while you're there, check out the adjoining Whiskey Museum. You can learn a lot about the drink you are sipping.

Hotel: Hotel Chur

<https://www.hotelchur.ch/>

Free garage parking; family-run with biker experience (praised for motorcycle trips); near train station and old town trails.

Day 4: Chur, Switzerland to Andermatt, Switzerland

(~215–230 km total, 5–6.5 hours pure riding time; plan 8–10 hours with stops and a relaxed pace. Significant elevation changes with the approach plus ~3,600 m on the loop itself.)

Start the day in Chur and ride west through the Rhine valley and over the scenic **Oberalp Pass** (or via the flatter valley route if you prefer less climbing early) to reach Andermatt. From there, tackle the three legendary passes in your requested order:

dramatic Furka first, Grimsel for lunch/views, and flowing Susten as the grand finale before settling into Andermatt for the night.

Segment 1: Chur to Andermatt (approx. 1 hr 45 min – 2 hr 15 min riding, 95–110 km via Oberalp Pass or valley roads)

Roll out of Chur along the Rhine, enjoying wide valley roads before climbing into high Alpine terrain—either the thrilling Oberalp Pass or the more direct valley route via Disentis.

- **Rhine Valley exit from Chur:** Smooth, fast roads heading west; fuel up if needed in Ilanz or Disentis.
- **Oberalp Pass option (2,044 m):** Sweeping hairpins with lake views and open meadows—classic Swiss riding with the Rhaetian Railway often visible below. (Recommended for the full experience; add ~30–45 min vs. the flatter route.)
- **Descent into Andermatt:** Drop into the Urseren Valley with the dramatic Schöllenen Gorge entrance—arrive in Andermatt ready for the big loop (quick coffee or fuel top-up here).

Segment 2: Andermatt to Furka Pass Summit (approx. 45–60 min, 25 km via Route 19)

Climb out of Andermatt via Realp into the high Alpine world—steep hairpins open up to vast glacier vistas as you gain altitude fast.

- **Realp village:** Quick fuel or coffee stop if needed; last proper services before the pass.
- **Furka Pass ascent (2,429 m):** Series of sweeping then tightening curves with Rhône Glacier peeking ahead. Road is narrow but grippy in good conditions.
- **Hotel Belvédère (key photo stop):** Iconic abandoned hotel with the famous James Bond-style hairpin right in front. Park safely and enjoy the dramatic Rhone Glacier viewpoint—perfect morning light on the ice fields.

Segment 3: Furka Pass to Grimsel Pass (approx. 30–45 min, 15 km via Gletsch)

Short, steep descent from Furka then immediate climb up Grimsel—raw high-alpine drama with rock walls and reservoirs.

- **Gletsch hamlet:** Tiny historic settlement at the valley floor; quick orientation point before the Grimsel climb.
- **Grimsel Pass ascent (2,165 m):** Starts with long sweepers, then tighter sections carved through granite. Hydro dams and sheer cliffs create an impressive engineered landscape.
- **Grimsel Pass summit & lakes:** Stop at **Grimsel Hospiz** or **Hotel Grimsel Passhöhe**—terrace with views over the turquoise reservoirs. Excellent spot for coffee, lunch, or a short walk. Many riders rate the panorama here as one of the best on the loop.

Segment 4: Grimsel Pass to Susten Pass Summit (approx. 60–90 min, 40–45 km via Innertkirchen)

Longer flowing descent into the Haslital valley, then the rewarding climb up Susten—often called the most enjoyable of the three for its curves and scenery.

- **Descent to Innerktirchen:** Fast, green valley run with nice rhythm—watch for occasional traffic.
- **Susten Pass ascent (2,224 m):** Beautiful mix of sweeping corners, tight hairpins, multiple short tunnels, waterfalls, and glacier views (Steinsee area shines in afternoon light).
- **Susten Pass summit:** Panoramic viewpoint with fewer crowds than Furka. Great place for photos and a breather before the final descent.

Segment 5: Susten Pass back to Andermatt (approx. 45–60 min, 35–40 km via Wassen)

Enjoyable downhill run that closes the loop with dramatic gorge scenery on the approach to Andermatt.

- **Descent to Wassen:** Flowing curves and bridges—Susten's east side rewards smooth riding.
- **Wassen & Schöllenen Gorge:** Pass the famous church on the hill, then ride the narrow, steep-walled gorge with the legendary Devil's Bridge views. Dramatic finale back into Andermatt.

Overnight: Hotel 3 Könige & Post, Andermatt

Central location right in the historic town center on Gotthardstrasse. Motorcycle-friendly with secure parking (underground garage or dedicated spots commonly used by riders). Traditional Swiss hotel with charm, on-site restaurant for a well-earned dinner, and comfortable rooms—many with mountain views. Book ahead in peak season; it's a popular base for pass riders.

This gives you a full but rewarding day: a scenic approach from Chur in the morning, the complete Holy Trinity in your preferred order, and a relaxed arrival in Andermatt by late afternoon/early evening. Ride at your own pace, check pass conditions the night before, and enjoy the variety—from valley roads to high-alpine drama.

Day 5: Andermatt, Switzerland to Menaggio, Italy

(~220–250 km total, 4.5–5.5 hours pure riding time; plan 7–9 hours with stops, lunch, and relaxed lakeside riding. A comfortable day descending from the Alps into warm Italian lake scenery with plenty of time to enjoy the views without rushing.)

Leave Andermatt after a leisurely breakfast and drop south over the Gotthard into Italy. Spend the morning on the scenic western shore of Lake Maggiore, then ride east to the iconic winding roads of Lake Como for the afternoon and evening.

Segment 1: Andermatt to Lake Maggiore (approx. 2–2.5 hrs, 110–120 km via Gotthard Pass/Tunnel + Locarno)

Smooth descent from the high Alps through the Ticino region into the warmer northern end of Lake Maggiore.

- **Gotthard Pass or Tunnel:** Choose the old scenic Gotthard Pass road (hairpins and views) if the weather is good, or the quicker tunnel to save energy.
- **Airolo to Locarno:** Fast valley run that opens up as you reach the lake area.

- **Lake Maggiore western shore (Italy side):** Ride south along the beautiful lakeside road through Cannobio and Verbania — calm waters, elegant villas, and mountain backdrops. Stop for coffee or photos in one of the pretty towns.

Segment 2: Lake Maggiore to Lake Como (approx. 1.5 hrs, 70–80 km via Varese or Lugano area)

Short, pleasant transfer east on secondary roads, avoiding highways where possible, arriving at the northern or western side of Lake Como.

- **Transition roads:** Gentle hills and quiet countryside lanes leading toward Menaggio or the western shore.
- **Arrival at Lake Como:** Begin riding the famous lakeside route with its tight twists, short tunnels, and stunning steep mountain scenery rising directly from the water.

Segment 3: Lake Como Exploration (approx. 1.5–2 hrs riding with stops, 40–60 km)

Focus on the best central section of the lake — the most scenic and enjoyable part for motorcyclists.

- **Western & central shore:** Ride through towns like Menaggio, Argegno, or toward Bellagio — flowing curves hugging the lake with luxury villas and gardens.
- **Key highlights:** Stop in **Menaggio** or **Varenna** for lunch with lake views, gelato, or a short stroll. The road here offers a perfect mix of smooth riding and dramatic scenery without feeling overcrowded mid-week.

Suggested Overnight: Menaggio or Varenna area on the central/northern part of Lake Como

This is an excellent ending point after touring both lakes west to east. Menaggio and Varenna offer a relaxed lakeside atmosphere, good restaurants, ferry access if you want to explore more, and plenty of motorcycle-friendly hotels with secure parking. The central location lets you enjoy the best of Como without the heavier traffic found further south near the city of Como.

Recommended spot: A bike-friendly hotel in **Menaggio** (such as those in the lakeside promenade area) or **Varenna** (very picturesque with easy access to the waterfront). These towns have a good selection of 3–4 star hotels popular with riders — many provide secure parking, hearty breakfasts, and views over the lake. Book ahead in the riding season as they fill up.

This revised day feels much more relaxed: you get the full experience of two beautiful lakes with time to soak in the Italian vibe, without the long push to Garda. You'll arrive at your overnight with energy left for dinner by the water.

Day 6: Menaggio, Italy to Bolzano, Italy

(~240–260 km total, 5–6 hours pure riding time; plan 8–10 hours with generous stops, lunch, and photos. A spectacular transition from glamorous lakeside riding through terraced vineyards and orchards to the ultimate alpine hairpin masterpiece.)

Start the day relaxed in Menaggio after breakfast and ride north along Lake Como's dramatic eastern shore before swinging into the wide Valtellina valley. The route builds beautifully to the iconic Passo dello Stelvio (2,757 m) with its 48 legendary hairpins, then drops into the charming bilingual South Tyrol region surrounded by Dolomites peaks.

Segment 1: Menaggio to Colico / Start of Valtellina (approx. 45–60 min, 35–40 km via SP583 / SP72 eastern shore)

Enjoy one of Italy's most glamorous lakeside rides — tight, tunnel-carved curves hugging the steep eastern arm of Lake Como with turquoise water below and elegant villas dotting the cliffs.

- **Menaggio to Domaso / Bellano area:** Sweeping corners and short tunnels with constant lake views; watch for occasional local traffic and parked scooters.
- **Northern end of Lake Como:** Pass through picturesque villages like Bellano (famous for its Orrido gorge if you want a quick stop) before the road opens up toward Colico.
- **Transition to Valtellina:** Smooth roads lead into the wide valley flanked by terraced vineyards and the Adda River — classic northern Italian alpine scenery begins here.

Segment 2: Valtellina Valley to Bormio (approx. 1.5–2 hrs, 80–90 km via SS38)

Flowing valley riding through one of Italy's premier wine and food regions — terraced vines, apple orchards, and historic towns create a relaxed, gourmet-paced segment.

- **Morbegno and Sondrio:** Cruise past charming towns with opportunities for a quick espresso or to admire the vineyard-covered slopes.
- **Valtellina highlights:** Rolling roads with the river on one side and steep, terraced mountains on the other — perfect for enjoying the scenery at a comfortable pace.
- **Arrival in Bormio:** Historic mountain town and natural gateway to the Stelvio; ideal for fuel, a light lunch, or last-minute layers before the big climb.

Segment 3: Bormio to Stelvio Pass Summit (approx. 45–70 min, 20–25 km via SS38)

The grand climax — Europe's most famous motorcycle pass with relentless hairpins, high-alpine drama, and breathtaking glacial views.

- **Stelvio ascent from Bormio (eastern side):** Approximately 48 legendary switchbacks carved into the mountainside; the road is narrow, steep, and incredibly rewarding with ever-expanding panoramas.
- **Upper sections:** Hairpins tighten as you gain altitude quickly; look for marmots, cyclists, and dramatic rock faces.
- **Stelvio Pass summit (2,757 m):** Iconic photo stop at the top with views over glaciers and peaks. Grab a quick bratwurst or coffee at the summit rifugio — the thrill of conquering one of the world's greatest riding roads hits hard here.

Segment 4: Stelvio Pass to Bolzano (approx. 1.5–2 hrs, 90–100 km via Val Venosta and Merano)

Thrilling descent followed by smooth, scenic roads through orchards, spa towns, and South Tyrol's wine valleys — a perfect cool-down into Dolomites territory.

- **Descent to Prato allo Stelvio / Glorenza:** Tight turns on the western side give way to the lush Val Venosta with blooming orchards and meadows (especially beautiful in mid-June with apple blossoms).

- **Merano:** Ride through this elegant spa town with palm trees and mountain backdrop — a nice contrast after the high pass.
- **Final approach to Bolzano:** Smooth roads through South Tyrol's wine country with jagged Dolomites peaks rising dramatically ahead.

Hotel: Parkhotel Laurin (Via Laurin 14, 39100 Bolzano). Rooftop pool and monitored lot; biker-favorite for its Art Nouveau style and Wine Road proximity.

Day 7: Return to Munich, Germany | 360 km, 6.5 hr

Hotel: Holiday Inn Express Munich Airport

The 6-hour, 358 km drive via SS508 (Passiria Valley) crests the dramatic Timmelsjoch High Alpine Road (typically open from late May, with clear conditions by mid-June), dips into Austria's Ötztal for glacier peeks, then races the Inn Valley before tackling Möserer Pass into Bavaria's beer gardens. Mid-June paints South Tyrol's larch forests in fresh green, carpets meadows with alpine roses and gentians, and delivers 15–25°C valley days (8–15°C on passes—fleece essential) under endless blue skies, with melt-fed streams roaring. Tolls: ~€15–20 for Austrian/Swiss vignettes + German autobahn; borders seamless. This Südtirol-to-Bayern epic mixes Tyrolean trails with Allgäu charm—watch for cyclists on hairpins.

Segment 1: Bolzano to Rio Bianco (38 min, 35.1 km via SS508)

Launch up Val Passiria's apple orchards and hay barns—Südtirol's "Secret Valley" unfurls with bilingual signs and cowbells.

- **Bolzano Start:** Arcaded Via dei Portici buzzes with mid-June markets hawking speck and strawberries; the Gothic Duomo's spires frame Ötzi's eternal ice backdrop at the archaeology museum (€13, quick peek).
- **Passiria Valley Ascent:** Past Merano's palm oases, SS508 winds through St. Martin's larch groves heavy with pollen-gold light; spot Meraner Land's castle ruins like Juval (Falstaff's perch)—June's elderflower blooms scent the air.
- **Rio Bianco Arrival:** "White River" hamlet at 1,000m; the cascading Rio Bianco falls thunder from snowmelt—short 10-min trail to the viewpoint for ibex silhouettes against Ortler peaks.

Segment 2: Rio Bianco to Gasteig (37 min, 31.3 km via SS508 to SS44)

Climb the valley's narrowing gorge, veering onto SS44 for Jaufen Pass previews—limestone walls echo with stream song.

- **Dosso Stretch (~15 min):** Narrow defiles with wild thyme banks; pull over at Plan's waterfalls for mist-kissed photos—mid-June's thaw creates rainbow veils.
- **SS44 Jaufen Junction:** Brief saddle at 2,094m with 360° sweeps of Stubai Alps; edelweiss fringes the road—quick espresso at a malga with valley quilt views.
- **Gasteig Hamlet:** Tucked in larch shade; the Romanesque church's frescoes glow—perfect pause for a Südtiroler Apfelstrudel amid blooming ramps.

Segment 3: Gasteig to Timmelsjoch (57 min + 30 min, 62.9 km via SS44 to Timmelsjochstrasse)

The route's thrill: 30+ hairpins up Europe's "Pass of a Thousand Turns" to 2,474m—an engineering marvel with open-top panoramas.

- **Moos in Passeier (~20 min in):** Passeier Tal's cultural core; Gasthof Moos serves canederli dumplings with balcony views of the pass ahead—June's wild garlic carpets slopes.
- **Timmelsjoch Ascent:** Switchbacks past Passo del Rombo's customs post (WWI echoes); mid-June's melt feeds roadside brooks—stop at the 3,000m viewpoint for Ortler Glacier's blue crevasses and Sesvenna's jagged teeth.
- **Timmelsjoch Summit:** Border-straddling wow with the "Pass Museum" (€7, multimedia on smuggling lore); hike the 20-minute Finsterbachweg for marmot calls and eternal snowfields—June sun gilds the Italian-Austrian divide.

Segment 4: Timmelsjoch to Ötztal Bahnhof (1 hr 11 min, 61.4 km via B186)

Gentle Ötztal descent into glacier-fed valleys—shift to Austria's turquoise streams and timber chalets.

- **Umhaus Border (~5 min):** Quick hop with no checks; the pass's stone Madonna chapel bids farewell.
- **Gurgl Valley (B186, ~30–45 min):** Past Sölden's Ötztal Arena (James Bond's *Spectre* set); mid-June's almwiesen (alpine meadows) burst with cow parades—detour to Obergurgl's 1,930m "Highest Parish" for eternal ice hikes.
- **Ötztal Bahnhof Arrival:** Valley railhead with the Ötzi Trail start; grab a Käsespätzle at a Gasthaus, eyes on the 3,000m+ Ötztaler peaks still dusted white.

Segment 5: Ötztal to Telfs (via E60, 13 min + 1 hr 1 min to Eschenlohe, 83.7 km total to Möserer)

Inn Valley autobahn efficiency meets Karwendel's limestone drama—flatter with Ziller Valley vineyard flashes.

- **Inntal Autobahn (E60, first 20 min):** Rhine-born Inn rushes parallel; spot Innsbruck's Nordkette cable cars soaring—June's hop fields scent the air near Hall.
- **Telfs Stretch:** Tyrolean market town; the Loisach River's fly-fishing spots gleam—quick stop at the frescoed parish church.
- **Möserer Pass (B177, ~45 min in):** 1,907m saddle with hairpin thrills; mid-June's green wave rolls to Wettersteinwand's sheer walls—pullout for wild rose arches framing Garmisch below.

Segment 6: Eschenlohe to Munich (37 min + 19 min, 80.3 km via A95, B2R)

Bavarian blitz down the Loisach to Isar—autobahn hums with Allgäu cow parades.

- **Garmisch-Partenkirchen (~20 min):** Olympic town's chalet facades; flash the Zugspitze cable (€60 round-trip) for Germany's highest peak—June's edelweiss hikes call.
- **A95 Descent:** Karwendel's final bows; Werdenfels region's frescoed Gasthäuser dot the way.
- **Munich Finale:** Olympiapark's towers welcome; end at Frankfurter Ring with a Weißbier in the English Garden—mid-June's lilac blooms perfume the Isar banks.

Alpine artistry from vineyards to bierkellers—drive steadily on Timmelsjoch. Check <https://www.timmelsjoch.com/> for cams. Sichere Fahrt!

Departure

Resources:



Pass Conditions & Road Info

Grossglockner Alpine Road: www.grossglockner.at

Timmelsjoch Pass Webcams: www.timmelsjoch.com

Swiss Pass Status: www.alpen-paesse.ch

Italian Road Conditions: www.viabilita.it



Hotels

Erding — Hotel zum ERDINGER Weißbräu:

Lienz — Grandhotel Lienz: | grandhotel-lienz.com

Schlanders — Hotel Engel: | mein-tourenhotel.de

Chur — Hotel Chur: www.hotelchur.ch

Andermatt — Hotel 3 Könige & Post: (book direct — central on Gotthardstrasse)

Bolzano — Parkhotel Laurin:



Motorcycle Rentals — Munich

Allround Motorcycle Renting (Recommended): www.motorradvermietung.de/muenchen/en/

Bike & Travel Service: www.bike-travel-service.de

BMW Rent a Ride: www.rentaride.bmw-motorrad.com

Moto Tours Europe: www.mototourseurope.com/rent-a-motorcycle



Useful Apps & Resources

Motorcycle Friendly Hotels: www.mein-tourenhotel.de

Alps Motorcycling Guide: mototrip-tours.com/blog/alps-and-dolomites

Alps Intro Video: youtu.be/vG-Bgdx7L8

Smallest Whisky Bar on Earth: smallestwhiskybaronearth.com

Metric to Imperial Conversion (km x 0.6):

km	mi
50	~30
100	~60
150	~90
200	~120
250	~160
300	~190
350	~220
400	~250